

What Star Is This

- 1 What star is this, with beams so bright,
more beauteous than the noonday light?
It shines to herald forth the King,
and Gentiles to his crib to bring.
- 2 True spake the prophet from afar
who told the rise of Jacob's star;
and eastern sages with amaze
upon the wondrous token gaze.
- 3 The guiding star above is bright;
within them shines a clearer light,
and leads them on with pow'r benign
to seek the Giver of the sign.
- 4 O Jesus, while the star of grace
impels us on to seek thy face,
let not our slothful hearts refuse
the guidance of thy light to use.

Words: Charles Coffin, 1736; tr. Hymns Ancient and Modern, 1861, after John Chandler, ca. 1837; alt.

Music: Trier manuscript, 15th cent.; adapt. Michael Praetorius, 1609; harm. George R. Woodward, 1910

Tune: PUER NOBIS · LM · Scripture: Matthew 2:1

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